



User Manual

English

familybiz.online

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1. Getting Started

FamilyBiz is a cloud-based rental property management platform designed for landlords and tenants in East Africa. It streamlines room listing, tenant screening, payment processing, and communication between property owners and renters.

System URLs

- Frontend: <https://familybiz.online>
- API: <https://api.familybiz.online>

Account Types

- **Super Admin** - Full system access: manage landlords, tenants, rooms, and system-wide settings.
- **Landlord** - Manage own rooms, tenants, payments, announcements, and gallery.
- **Tenant** - Browse available rooms, make payments, submit feedback, and view announcements.

Key Features

- Room management with status tracking (Available, Occupied, Maintenance)
- Integrated payment processing via ClickPesa with manual landlord confirmation
- Photo gallery with lightbox viewer for each property
- Bilingual support: English and Kiswahili (280+ translation keys)
- Real-time notifications for new payments via 30-second polling

2. Account Registration & Login

Registering an Account

New users can register at **/register**. During registration, select your role as either **Landlord** or **Tenant**.

Registration Fields

- Last Name
- Email Address
- Phone Number
- Password

Logging In

Navigate to **/login** and enter your email and password. The system redirects you to the appropriate dashboard based on your account role.

Password Recovery

If you forget your password, visit **/forgot-password**, enter your registered email, and follow the instructions sent to your inbox.

Language Toggle

The sidebar includes a language toggle button to switch between English and Kiswahili at any time. All interface text, labels, and messages update immediately.

3. Super Admin Dashboard

The Super Admin dashboard is accessed at **/admin**. The admin badge appears in **orange amber** to distinguish this account type.

System Overview

The overview tab displays key statistics in summary cards:

- Total number of registered landlords
- Total number of registered tenants
- Total rooms across the entire system

These stats update in real-time as landlords and tenants are added or removed.

Manage Landlords

A searchable table lists all registered landlords with the following capabilities:

- Search by name, email, or phone
- Toggle a landlord's active/inactive status with one click
- Reset any landlord's password using the default pattern

Manage Tenants

A searchable table lists all registered tenants with:

- Search by name, email, or phone
- View the currently assigned room for each tenant
- Toggle tenant active/inactive status
- Reset any tenant's password

All Rooms

A system-wide room list showing every property across all landlords with columns for Room Number, Type, Price, Status, and Assigned Landlord.

Password Reset

The password reset modal generates a new password using the default pattern: **LASTNAME@YEAR!** (e.g., Mwangi@2026!). The new password is displayed for the admin to share with the user.

4. Landlord Dashboard

The Landlord dashboard is accessed at **/landlord**. It provides a comprehensive interface for managing properties, tenants, and finances.

Overview

The dashboard overview shows summary statistics, total revenue from confirmed payments, and recent activity feed.

Room Management

Landlords can create, edit, and delete rooms. Each room has:

- Room Number (unique identifier)
- Room Type (Single, Double, or custom type)
- Price (monthly rent amount)
- Status: Available (green), Occupied (amber), Maintenance (gray)
- Photo Upload: images stored as base64 in the system

Rooms can be edited or deleted at any time. Uploading photos is optional but recommended for better tenant engagement.

Payment Management

Landlords can view all payments made by their tenants. Each payment entry shows the amount, method, status, and date. Actions include:

- **Confirm** - Accept a pending payment
- **Reject** - Decline a payment (with optional reason)

Unconfirmed Payments

A bell notification icon shows the count of pending payments. The system polls every **30 seconds** for new payment submissions. Clicking the bell opens a confirm/reject modal with payment details.

Payment Methods

Landlords manage which payment methods are accepted. Common methods include bank transfer, mobile money (M-Pesa), and cash payment.

Announcements

Create posts to share updates, notices, or important information with all tenants. Announcements appear in the tenant dashboard and can include rich text content.

Comments

View and respond to tenant feedback and comments. This feature enables two-way communication between landlords and tenants.

Entertainment

The entertainment section provides sports-related content for tenants, serving as a value-added feature of the platform.

House Gallery

The gallery displays uploaded room photos in a responsive grid. Features include:

- Hover overlay with room details
- Lightbox viewer for full-size images
- View All / Show Less toggle for managing large collections

Profile

Edit personal information including name, email, and phone number. Change language preference and reset account password from the profile section.

5. Tenant Dashboard

The Tenant dashboard is accessed at **/tenant**. It provides tools for room selection, payment, and communication with the landlord.

Room Selection

Tenants can browse all available rooms listed by their landlord. Each room displays its number, type, price, and current status. Only rooms marked as Available can be selected.

Payment Flow

The payment process follows a simple three-step flow:

- Step 1: Select a room from the available listings
- Step 2: Choose a payment method (bank transfer, mobile money, etc.)
- Step 3: Confirm payment details and submit

After submission, the payment enters a **Pending** status awaiting landlord confirmation.

Cancelling Payments

Tenants can cancel a pending payment with one click. This immediately changes the payment status to Cancelled and frees the room for other tenants.

Late Payment Reasons

If a payment is late, tenants can submit reasons for the delay. This helps landlords understand tenant circumstances and make informed decisions.

Critical Remarks

Tenants can view critical remarks left by the landlord regarding their account, payments, or tenancy history.

Announcements

Read posts and updates published by the landlord. Announcements are displayed in chronological order with the most recent first.

Comments

Submit feedback, suggestions, or concerns to the landlord through the comments section. This is a direct communication channel for tenants.

House Gallery

Browse photos of available and assigned rooms. The gallery features a lightbox viewer, responsive grid layout, and placeholder images for rooms without photos.

Rules & Policies

View community guidelines, house rules, and tenancy policies as defined by the landlord. These guidelines help maintain a positive living environment.

Profile Management

Edit personal information, change language preferences, and update password from the profile section.

6. Payment System

FamilyBiz integrates with **ClickPesa** for online payment processing. After a tenant initiates a payment, the system records it and waits for the landlord to manually confirm or reject the transaction.

Payment Statuses

Status	Description	Effect
Pending	Payment submitted, awaiting landlord review	Bell notification shown to landlord
Confirmed	Landlord approved the payment	Room status updated, tenant notified
Failed	Payment was rejected or transaction failed	Tenant can retry or contact landlord
Cancelled	Tenant cancelled before confirmation	Room freed, no further action

Late Payment Reasons

Tenants can submit reasons for late payments. These entries are recorded and visible to landlords, enabling them to understand delays and provide extensions when appropriate.

7. Room Management

Room Statuses

Status	Color	Description
Available	Green	Room is open for new tenants
Occupied	Amber	Room currently has an active tenant
Maintenance	Gray	Room is under repair or unavailable

Room Types

- **Single** - Standard single-occupancy room
- **Double** - Larger room for two occupants
- Custom types can be added by landlords

Photo Upload

Room photos are uploaded and stored as base64 strings within the database. Supported formats include JPEG, PNG, and WebP. Multiple photos can be uploaded per room.

Gallery Display

The gallery renders photos in a responsive grid with:

- Hover overlay showing room number and type
- Lightbox viewer for full-screen image display
- View All / Show Less toggle for collections

8. Translations & Settings

Bilingual Support

FamilyBiz supports **English** and **Kiswahili** with over 280 translation keys per language. The language toggle in the sidebar switches the entire interface instantly.

Language Toggle

Click the language button in the sidebar to switch between English and Kiswahili. All labels, messages, buttons, and notifications update in real-time.

Profile Settings

Every user can edit their profile information:

- Full name
- Email address
- Phone number
- Language preference (persistent across sessions)

Password Reset

Users can change their password from the profile section. Super Admins can reset passwords for any user via the admin dashboard using the default pattern: **LASTNAME@YEAR!**